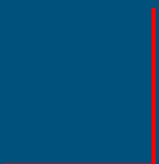


The American Dream

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What is the American Dream?

- ★ Breaking through barriers that would have held you back
- ★ Pushing past barriers of stereotypes and discrimination
- ★ Proving to be successful despite racial prejudice



"A Dream Deferred"

By Brian Washington

This painting by Brian Washington depicts the civil rights struggle faced for centuries by activists fighting for a free and equal society. This shows people showing defiant faith and nonviolent tactics in the face of violence and brutality. It is called "A Dream Deferred" in honor of the poem by Langston Hughes which speaks on how everyone should feel free to pursue their dreams, which unfortunately is not necessarily the case for everyone in America.

This symbolizes both Hughes' poem "Let America be America Again" and "A Raisin in the Sun" because both have themes relating to dreams and the unfortunate reality which does not allow them for every person. It is a harsh depiction of the way African Americans specifically have been treated fighting for civil rights and their struggle to overcome prejudice.

“Let America Be America Again” by Langston Hughes

- ★ Poem describing the harsh reality in America of treatment for non-white Americans and is a beg for freedom for all those who are oppressed
- ★ Hughes explains that America is made up of all kinds of people and the struggles they have faced trying to attain this “dream”
- ★ It is supposed to be ‘the land of the free’ with ‘liberty and justice for all’, but it is not that way for most



"Am I part of the American Dream?"

By Alexandra Hogan

This is a drawing by Alexandra Hogan titled "Am I Part of the American Dream" from 2016. This represents the poem by Langston Hughes perfectly. It shows a young Black girl holding the American flag shaped like a spear. It is sharp and she looks at it with concern because she doesn't believe that what it represents is meant for her. Hughes' poem discusses all of the things America stands for and how it is not easily attainable or accessible to everyone.

“Farewell to Manzanar” by Jeanne Wakatsuki Houston

- ★ Autobiography of Japanese-American Jeanne Wakatsuki Houston’s childhood experiences in an internment camp after WWII (1942)
- ★ This created deep-rooted prejudice instead of physical expressions of hatred
 - More common to develop unconscious bias than outright hostility
- ★ Racial stereotyping was a major part of the US government’s propaganda campaign during WWII
 - This made people associate Japanese people with evil
- ★ The author struggles with her Japanese identity; ultimately embraces her culture
- ★ Proves the hatred Japanese-Americans have faced and how they have overcome it

many people associated Japanese people the way the government portrayed them to be (evil, not human)



Photograph of a consoling tower at Manzanar National Historic Site in Inyo County
By Elson Trinidad

This is a photo of a landmark in the cemetery at the northwestern corner of Manzanar National Historic Site in Inyo County, where over 10,000 Japanese Americans were interned here during World War II.

Today, following years of reparations, redress, and remembrance, Manzanar stands as a National Historic Site, run by the National Park Service, as a living history lesson and reminder of a regrettable time in our country's past.

This helps represent Farewell to Manzanar because it serves as a reminder of what Japanese-Americans have had to go through and a way to acknowledge their strength.

“Fourth of July (View from La Frontera)” by Felipe Galindo-Feggo

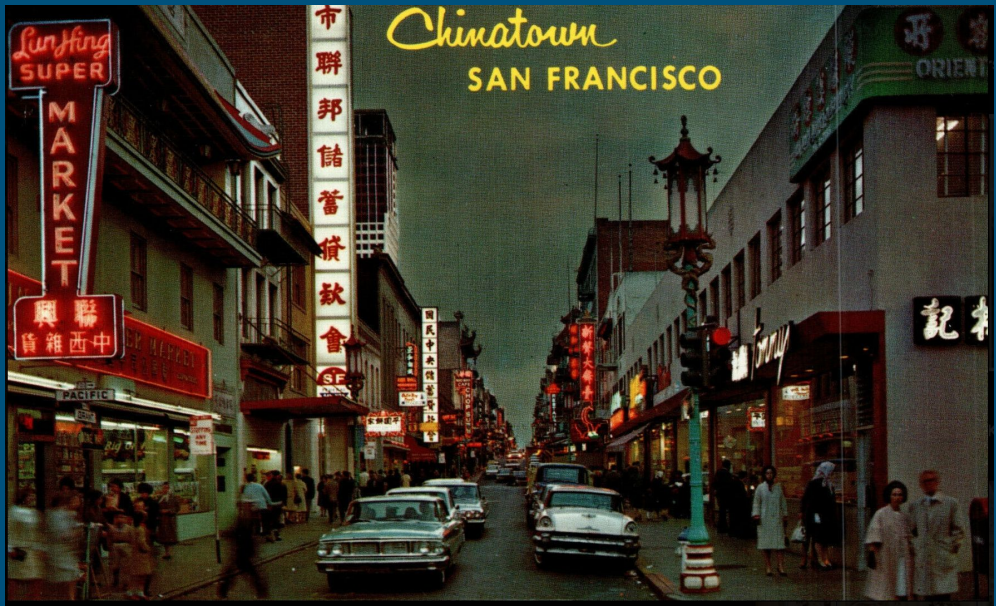
- ★ Painting depicting the Mexican-American border, showing the discrimination of what only certain Americans can experience
- ★ Shows what immigrants experience and their struggle to be accepted in this country



This is the painting by Felipe Galindo-Feggo's View from La Frontera (Fourth of July). This illustrates breaking through barriers that hold them back from the freedom they deserve. It is a harsh depiction of what Mexican-American immigrants go through even today and how they struggle to be accepted in this country.

“Tripmaster Monkey” by Maxine Hong Kingston

- ★ Fictional novel about a Chinese-American boy growing up in the 1960s who is conflicted about his Chinese heritage
 - He looks down on immigrants because he is ashamed of his own ancestry
- ★ Whittman Ah Sing creates an alter ego and world through art that is devoid of stereotypes
- ★ The conflict in the story illustrates the struggles non-white Americans have faced and how it has affected their sense of self
- ★ The story proves that it is possible to break free from stereotypes and become successful in America despite them

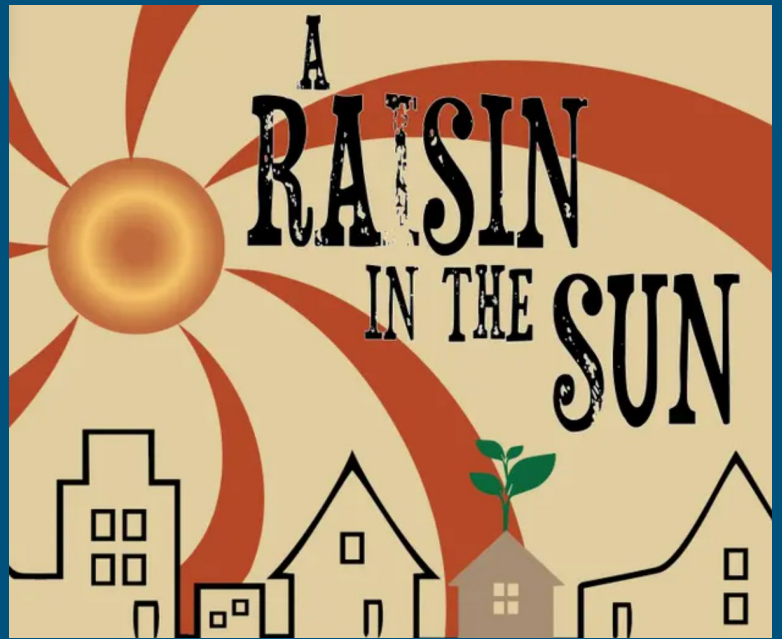


Photograph of Grant Avenue in Chinatown, San Francisco

San Francisco is considered the original Chinatown. In early Chinatown San Francisco, many found that their new life was just as tough or worse than their old one. A combination of racism, the often lawless nature of early California (even when the law itself didn't discriminate against them) and the general difficulties of trying to establish themselves in a new country, with a different language and customs, created huge obstacles for Chinese immigrants. This represents Tripmaster Monkey because the main character Whittman Ah Sing lives here and is conflicted about his Chinese heritage. However, he is a direct representation of Chinatown in America. While Chinatown can be seen as stereotypical, it is actually truly authentic and cultural in its own way, which is what the character of Whittman is.

“A Raisin in the Sun” by Lorraine Hansberry

- ★ Play about a Black family in 1950s Chicago and their dreams for the future
- ★ Mama wants to move to a better neighborhood but a white man tries to bribe them to reconsider
 - Proving racism and discrimination
- ★ Main idea is that racial discrimination constantly threatens to stand in the way the family's dreams
- ★ Each family member worked hard to break beyond barriers that would normally hold them back
 - Beneatha becoming a doctor; Mama buying a house in a predominantly white neighborhood



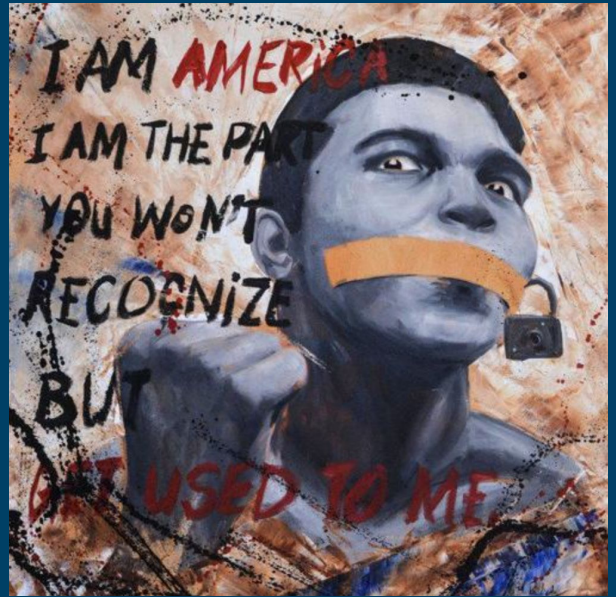
A poster from a stage version of A Raisin in the Sun in Beverly Arts Center in Chicago

A Raisin in the Sun is about one family's dreams of being and doing more. This poster for a play version of the story is a perfect representation of the main idea of the story. It shows a row of houses with one looking shaded in that has a green sprout growing out of it all under one big sun. The Younger family strives to live in a better neighborhood and all individually have dreams of a better life. This represents their house full of aspirations and how they are standing up and thriving in the face of discrimination.

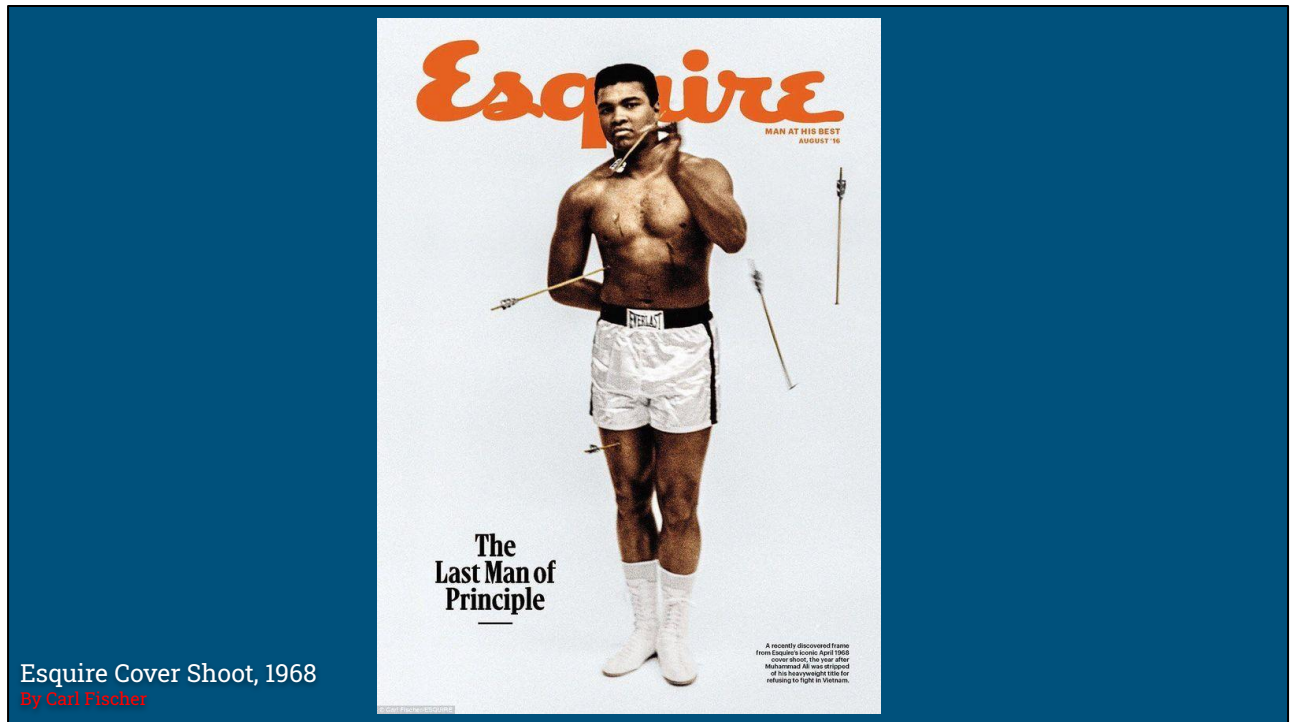
"I Am America"

By Michael Roberts

- ★ Part of the American Dream at "Arts Illiana" in Indiana
- ★ Metaphor for the attempt to silence Muhammad Ali for his insistence on fighting against prejudice
 - Ali refused to fight in Vietnam due to religious reasons
 - His defiance proved he would not go against his beliefs



This is a painting of boxing legend Muhammad Ali, with his fist upheld and mouth taped and locked shut. Beside Ali's profile is one of his famously bold declarations, made early in his career: "I am America. I am the part you won't recognize. But get used to me." He was known for his Boxing Championships and his resistance to prejudice. This piece shows how someone will not be held back by prejudice. Muhammad Ali lived the American Dream growing up as a Black Muslim and a descendent of slaves in the South. His story proved that one can be successful and will not be silenced in the face of discrimination.



This is a photo of Esquire's iconic April 1968 cover shoot, the year after Muhammad Ali was stripped of his heavyweight title for refusing to fight in Vietnam. The caption on this photo is "The Last Man of Principle", which is an expression of his resistance to fight in the war. Ali was Muslim and therefore did not believe in fighting in the war, which he faced strong backlash and prejudice for. This picture demonstrates his resistance as well as his strength in the face of this prejudice. While the arrows are coming at him, he is actively holding one away from his face, showing he is stronger than the negativity that was associated with him.

“Address to the Commonwealth Club of California”

by Cesar Chavez

- ★ Speech given by Cesar Chavez in 1984 to raise awareness of the issues with the farm labor system in
- ★ The horrible treatment to farm workers and the horrific accidents they’ve dealt with
- ★ Stems from racism and prejudice farm workers face due to stereotyping
- ★ Chavez said farm workers are symbolic of the history of our land and America is nothing without them



Photograph of Cesar Chavez speaking with California grape growers
From the National Museum of American History

This is a photo of Cesar Chavez speaking with farm workers in California in 1970. The United Farm Workers organization was made to bring attention and change to the exploitation and harsh treatment faced by farm workers. Efforts centered in California quickly grew into a larger civil rights movement under César Chávez. His legacy remains an inspiration for the civil rights movements that continue in the United States today. This photo shows Chavez amidst farm workers as an inspiration to them and a symbol of hope for change.

“Asian American Dreams” by Helen Zia

- ★ Autobiographical novel about what it means to be Asian in America
 - Zia describes her personal experiences growing up in 1950s America
- ★ Discusses significant moments in history that impacted the Asian American community
 - Chinese-American Vincent Chin’s murder in 1982
- ★ “America can no longer afford to ignore these emergent, vital, and singular American people”
- ★ Zia expresses that it means something to have a name and know what that means in the complicated caste and culture system within America

This novel illustrates first hand experiences and memories on how Asian-Americans have evolved in this country as well as how they have adapted to the constant scrutiny because of their roots. Zia writes about how she has broken through prejudices of being a Chinese woman in America and became successful despite growing up a minority.



Photograph of Helen Zia participating in a Vincent Chin rally in Detroit in 1983
In China Times

Helen Zia, the writer of *Asian American Dreams*, is a huge activist and advocate for Asian American civil rights. Her book strongly expresses the discrimination Asian Americans of all cultures have faced growing up in 1950s America. She writes specifically about the murder of Chinese-American Vincent Chin in 1982 simply because of his appearance. Zia has constantly fought for the injustice of this treatment and prejudice Asians have dealt with in America and still continue to face today. This photo was taken of her in 1983 at a rally for Vincent Chin in Detroit, holding a sign saying "Oppose All Racial Attacks" in English and in Chinese. The murder of Vincent Chin was a turning point in the way Asian Americans dealt with this treatment and scrutiny and they realized they wouldn't stand by and watch their people be treated this way.

This represents her book because it shows how vigilant Asian Americans have been in the face of prejudice because of their background and how they will continue to overcome this.

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